

Summer Fellowship Program 2026

RESUME CHECKLIST

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Put time into polishing your resume and making sure it represents you and your professional abilities in the best light

Check for these components as you revise and polish your resume

Format

- At first glance, is the resume easy-to-read?
- Are the margins even and not too narrow/too wide?
- Is the font size legible and font type consistent?
- Are you using consistent headings, boldface/italicizing, punctuation and spacing?
- Are you consistent in displaying dates (e.g., consistently abbreviating or writing out months?)
- Is there enough white space on your resume?

Organization

- Are your experiences organized under clear section headings?
- If you used a chronological resume format, are your experiences listed in reverse chronological order (starting with the most recent and continuing back in the past) under each section header?
- Will the organization you've used (section headings, order of sections, order of bullet points) help the employer easily identify your most relevant experiences and skills for this role?
- Did you omit a "References" section? List references on a separate sheet if requested.

Content

- Did you include your name, phone number, email, and links to any relevant social media (e.g., LinkedIn), portfolios, personal websites, or examples of your work (e.g., Github)?
- Did you remove any first person pronouns, such as "I" and "we"?
- Do your bullet points start with a strong action verb?
- Did you use the present tense for current positions/responsibilities and past tense for completed positions/responsibilities for your action verbs?
- Do your bullet points address what you did, how you did it, and why you did it/the measurable impact of your work?
- Did you quantify and specify the scope of your work where possible?
- Do your bullet points showcase your transferable skills and technical tools in action (e.g., Are any technical skills listed under your Skills section also integrated into your bullet points?)
- Did you tailor your resume to incorporate keywords from the job description? Some employers use applicant tracking systems (ATS) to scan resume and cover letters for keywords found in their job descriptions and used in the industry.
- Did you avoid abbreviations (exception for state names) and jargon that your reader may not understand?
- Have you reviewed it multiple times to catch typos and inconsistencies?

FIRST NAME LAST NAME

Git Hub, or e-portfolio link

City, State (abbreviation) Zip

Phone Number

Email

OBJECTIVE

(Optional. Helpful if your resume doesn't clearly align with your career goals.)

EDUCATION

University Name, City, State (abbreviated)

Month, Year

Educational Qualification/Degree, Major

Minor(s): if applicable

GPA: include if 2.70 or higher (include 2 decimals); if your major GPA significantly exceeds your cumulative GPA, consider listing both; if you had a personal event/circumstance that greatly affected your overall GPA, consider listing your cumulative and then a semester GPA if it shows improvement (e.g. Overall GPA: 2.5; Spring 2016: 3.2)

Name of High School, City, State (abbreviated)

Month, Year

Awards: (e.g. Top 5% of Graduating Class, National Honor Society, National AP Scholar)

After sophomore year, remove most of your high school experience, unless directly relevant to the type of position sought. If your high school is well known and/or you are applying to an organization where alumni from your school work, you may choose to include the high school name, location and graduation date.

Relevant Courses: Spreadsheet-Based Modeling and Data Analysis; Industrial Data and Systems Analysis

List electives and other courses beyond the basics, noting any that are advanced for your year. Limit to 2-3 lines.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE/ENGINEER EXPERIENCE

Company Name, location, Title

Month, Year - Month, Year

- Proposed 7 alternative international vendors to reduce transportation costs by 80%
- Compiled 45-page technical report and analysis and presented to senior management
- Researched land transportation routes identifying optimal routes based on cost and time

*This section can include any experiences that are relevant to the type of position you are seeking; it may include project team, research, part-time jobs, previous internships, on-campus clubs, etc. For each of your experiences, you'll want to add descriptions. Start each sentence with a strong action verb (do not use first person or pronouns on your resume). Include **what** you did, **how** you did it, and **why** (for what purpose), focusing on the **results** and your **accomplishments**. **Quantify** results if you can.*

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Name of Lab/Department, University, location, Title

Month, Year - Present

- Collaborate with a 20+ person team to design and create an autonomous biped robot
- Serve as sole member of the Electronics team and design, test, and implement printable circuit boards and other circuitry using CAD software

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Name of Organization, location, *Title*

Month, Year – Month, Year

- Facilitated monthly meetings for executive board of 6 and weekly activities for 60+ members
- Collaborated with 5 students groups to organize campus events that raised \$2,000 for local charity

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Name of Organization, location, *Title*

Month, Year – Month, Year

This section can include work experience or other activities that may not be as relevant to the type of position you are seeking, but are worth noting because you developed transferable skills.

- Other potential sections: **PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE, WORK EXPERIENCE, CAMPUS INVOLVEMENT, COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT, ACADEMIC PROJECTS, ATHLETICS, INTERESTS**, etc.

Consider breaking experience into 2 main categories such as SOFTWARE EXPERIENCE and HARDWARE EXPERIENCE or TRANSPORTATION EXPERIENCE and STRUCTURAL EXPERIENCE. These are just some sample of sections you can include on your resume; you don't need to include them all.

SPECIALIZED SKILLS

Object Oriented Programming (Python, Basic Java); Computer Assisted Design (CADSoft EAGLE)

- **AI & Automation Tools:** ChatGPT, Gemini, Midjourney, Zapier, specific AI extensions relevant to your field.
- **Programming Languages:** Java, OCaml, Python, C++, C#, MATLAB, AMPL, C, Perl, Tcl, Simulink, LabVIEW, SQL, PHP, HTML, XML, UNIX, Visual Basic, Pascal, and Alice
- **Programs:** SolidWorks, ANSYS, Autodesk, AutoCAD, Adobe Creative Suite, Photoshop, Illustrator, Dreamweaver, InDesign, Professional, Final Cut, Inventor, Inkscape, Excel
- **Operating Systems:** Windows XP, Windows 7, Mac OS 9, Linux (Ubuntu & OpenSUSE)
- **Circuit Development:** gEDA gschem (schematic software), gEDA PCB (PCB layout software), Multisim, NI myDAQ, PCB construction (photo- and film-resist methods), reflow soldering
- **Fabrication Skills:** Operation of lathes and mills (Green Apron machinist at Cornell). Utilization of G code for CNC machining. Experience with arc welding, 3D printing, drills, sawing, wiring, soldering, welding, multimeters, oscilloscopes, and Genie lifts.
- **Manufacturing:** Okuma CNC Mill, Bridgeport Knee Mill, Hardinge and DoAll Lathes, general shop machines
- **Laboratory Skills:** nanocrystal synthesis, nanocrystal characterization (spectrometer), metal evaporation, spin-coating, external quantum efficiency measurements, device performance measurements (solar simulator).
- **Foreign Languages:** Spanish (fluent); French (intermediate)

Depending on how many skills you have, and how many categories they fall under, you can combine them, or list them under separate categories within the same section. For language skills, include your level of proficiency (i.e. basic, intermediate, advanced, fluent).

Formatting Tips:

- Minimum font size: 10 point; Minimum margin: .5"; Maximum margin: 1"; make right & left margin the same.
- Spell check: Word does not automatically check words in all uppercase.
- Be consistent, if you abbreviate states and months, make sure you do so throughout your resume.
- Use appropriate tense: present tense if current (e.g. Research); past tense if completed (e.g. Researched).
- Within each category, list experience in reverse chronological order by end date.
- Do not include "References Available Upon Request."
- Undergraduate resumes should be one page.

Big Picture: What is the story you wish to tell? What skills are you trying to emphasize?

Resume Review:

- *It's helpful to have others look at your resume. Consider what 3-5 things you most want an employer to know about you. Show your resume to a peer, mentor, supervisor, advisor, or professor and ask what stands out when they look at your resume. Are they the same things?*
- *Show your resume to a supervisor, colleague, or project leader and ask if the description you wrote paints an accurate and strong picture of your contributions*
- *Show your resume to someone with strong editing skills or attention to detail to be sure you don't have any mistakes.*

Make a list of experiences you've had and Think about what you contributed, what skills you used and developed, and your significant achievements from these experiences.

CRAFTING YOUR DESCRIPTION

STEP 1: Identify your transferable skills

Place a check mark next to each skill you possess. Think about all settings in which you may have used/developed each skill. Then, circle the ones you consider to be your top 10.

Communication & Creativity

- ☐ Writing clearly and concisely
- ☐ Listening attentively
- ☐ Expressing ideas
- ☐ Using media to present ideas
- ☐ Reporting information
- ☐ Public speaking
- ☐ Making presentations
- ☐ Describing feelings
- ☐ Improvising
- ☐ Doing more with less
- ☐ Appreciating diversity
- ☐ Cross-functional collaboration
- ☐ Providing accurate descriptions

Problem-Solving

- ☐ Anticipating potential problems
- ☐ Defining problems and possible causes
- ☐ Identifying and selecting solutions
- ☐ Creating innovative approaches
- ☐ Involving group members in problem-solving
- ☐ Developing plans to implement solutions
- ☐ Establishing general principles
- ☐ Teaching/training others
- ☐ Solving problems/mediating
- ☐ Implementing sound decisions
- ☐ Strategic adaptability/Navigating ambiguity

Research

- ☐ Forecasting/predicting
- ☐ Designing an experiment
- ☐ Imagining alternatives
- ☐ Identifying resources
- ☐ Extracting important information
- ☐ Defining needs
- ☐ Development strategies
- ☐ Formulating conclusions
- ☐ Conceptualizing ideas
- ☐ Observing and discovering
- ☐ Analyzing information
- ☐ Presenting findings
- ☐ Learning new tools/techniques

Leadership

- ☐ Managing and supervising groups
- ☐ Delegating responsibility
- ☐ Promoting and adapting to change
- ☐ Prioritizing tasks
- ☐ Identifying areas for improvement
- ☐ Facilitating meetings
- ☐ Coaching/mentoring/counseling
- ☐ Evaluating progress
- ☐ Giving praise and credit
- ☐ Setting and accomplishing goals
- ☐ Eliciting input and providing feedback

General Work

- ☐ Setting and meeting deadlines
- ☐ Accepting responsibility
- ☐ Enlisting help
- ☐ Editing/proofing
- ☐ Negotiating/persuading
- ☐ Seeking opportunities for professional growth
- ☐ Taking initiative
- ☐ Managing time and stress
- ☐ Responding well to feedback
- ☐ Remaining calm under pressure

Teamwork

- ☐ Generating and initiating ideas
- ☐ Making decisions with others
- ☐ Respecting others
- ☐ Developing rapport
- ☐ Sharing credit/cooperation
- ☐ Interacting effectively
- ☐ Collaborating in diverse or multicultural environment
- ☐ Meeting team expectations
- ☐ Perceiving feelings, situations
- ☐ Listening to others

STEP 2: Brainstorm examples of how you used each skill

Use **this template** to list your top 10 skills in the far-left column, then note the place(s) where you demonstrated each skill. Do not sweat the details here, you'll get to that in Step 3. Although the example below illustrates a skill in use across all three categories, some of your specific skills may have only be used on one or two.

Transferable Skill	Employment & Internship Experiences	Course Projects & Research	Campus and Community Activities
Example: Public speaking	End of summer presentation to department staff	Group presentation in class last semester	Submitted proposal for campus-wide event

STEP 3: Bring it all together with an accomplishment statement

Turn these general concepts into bullet points on your resume. You can **ACE** this part of resume writing by starting with an **Action Verb** to show you did something, providing the **Context** for that action using quantitative and qualitative terms and then demonstrating the **End Result** of your actions to show the value of your contributions.

Action Verb	Context	End Result
Example: Pitched	Idea for a "Princeton Popcorn" night to the Undergraduate Student Government	And ultimately created an event which attracted 300+ attendees to a 2-day student-run film festival

Step-by-Step of what you should pay attention when drafting your resume

Education

- The degree you are seeking, university name, college name, city and state of the university, your expected graduation date, and GPA.
- Coursework, academic awards, scholarships, and study abroad programs may also be included in this section.

Skills

- Include any tangible skills, such as computer language, technical, laboratory, and foreign language skills. Mention your strongest skills first.
- Avoid including transferable skills, like communication and problem solving, as these should be demonstrated in the experience section of your resume.

Example:

- Programs: MATLAB, Mathematica, AutoCAD, MS Word, Excel, PowerPoint
- Computer Languages: Java, C++
- Languages: Fluent in English

Experience

- Title, organization name and location, and dates of employment.
- Follow the formula: Action Verb + Details + Result (quantify if possible).
- Answer the following questions:
 - What you do/did?
 - How you do/did it?
 - What was the result?

Example:

- Weak Skills Statement: "Used problem solving skills "
- Strong Skills Statement: "Implemented a new statistical tracking method that reduced the average error rate by **14 percent**"

- Avoid using personal pronouns such as "I, my, and we".
- Verbs are in the correct tense (past tense for past experiences and present tense for current experiences).
- List your experiences in reverse chronological order (most recent first).

Pro-Tip: You can use AI (like Gemini or ChatGPT) to help brainstorm your Action + Details + Result bullet points. However, always rewrite them in your own voice. Recruiters can easily spot AI-generated jargon. Authenticity and personal impact are your best differentiators.

Projects

- Describe individual or group projects you have done to demonstrate your ability to apply classroom learning to real-life problems.
- Projects can include those done as part of coursework, independently, and through student group involvement.

Activities

List involvements with student organizations, volunteer experience, and professional associations.

- Include the organization name, dates of participation, and possibly a bulleted statement to explain a leadership role or accomplishment.

What if you have little to no projects & activities? If there's no extracurricular activities, pay attention to academic achievements and expand on that (see transferable skills worksheet)

How to build good “Experience” and “Project” parts

Tailor your resume to the job description

- If certain keywords, skills, or traits keep popping up, check that they are reflected in your resume in your own words.
- Applicant Tracking System (demonstrate with sample job description, highlight words that might show on ATS)
 - Directly address qualifications found in the job descriptions and add keywords (if they apply to you). Use the exact same phrasing as the job description in your resume. i.e. “B.S.” versus “Bachelor of Science”
 - Make minor adjustments for technical skills i.e. If a requirement in the job posting is “SolidWorks,” include that instead of a generic “CAD”.
 - Utilize transferable skill buzz-words such as “communicate effectively” or “lead a team of...”
 - How to avoid ATS traps:

Dos	Don'ts
➤ Follow the employer's instructions. ➤ Use standard headings for sections. ➤ Use 11-point font – nothing smaller. ➤ Use standard typefaces – no scripts. ➤ Use single-column format. ➤ Use one action word per line.	➤ Don't include tables or graphics. ➤ Don't use headers or footers. ➤ Don't use templates or special characters. ➤ Don't use lines or borders.

Transferable Skills

- What was the result/outcome of your work?
- Did you increase customer satisfaction?
- Did you improve the algorithms?
- What were your accomplishments?
- How did you impact the organization?
- What skills/knowledge did you grow?
- How does this experience relate to your internship/employment goal?
 - Have I ever achieved something? Achieved more with fewer resources? Reduced costs? Increased productivity? Increased recruitment numbers? Designs developed? Presented complex information clearly?
- Examples:

Communication & Creativity

- Writing clearly and concisely
- Listening attentively

Leadership

- Managing and supervising groups
- Delegating responsibility

Teamwork

- Generating and initiating ideas
- Making decisions with others

General Work

- Setting and meeting deadlines
- Accepting responsibility

Problem-Solving

- Anticipating potential problems
- Defining problems and possible causes

Research

- Formulating conclusions
- Conceptualizing ideas

Action-oriented accomplishment statement

➤ Example:

- Allocated \$1,500 budget to promote annual National Coming Out Day rally, increasing participation 25% over previous year.
- Coordinated three fundraising events for local shelters, raising \$8,000 and greatly improving community awareness.
- Collaborated with a partner to formalize a 400-page training curriculum, creating a structure that made the progression of material clear and logical.

Consider using these verbs when writing your experiences' descriptions.

LEADERSHIP

Accomplished	Achieved	Administered	Analyzed
Contracted	Coordinated	Delegated	Developed
Handled	Headed	Impacted	Improved
Organized	Oversaw	Planned	Predicted
Regulated	Reorganized	Reviewed	Scheduled
Assigned	Attained	Chaired	Consolidated
Directed	Earned	Evaluated	Executed
Increased	Led	Mastered	Orchestrated
Prioritized	Produced	Proved	Recommended
Spearheaded	Strengthened	Supervised	Surpassed

COMMUNICATION

Addressed	Arbitrated	Arranged	Authored
Developed	Directed	Documented	Drafted
Influenced	Interpreted	Lectured	Liaised
Presented	Promoted	Publicized	Reconciled
Suggested	Synthesized	Translated	Verbalized
Collaborated	Convinced	Corresponded	Delivered
Edited	Energized	Enlisted	Formulated
Mediated	Moderated	Negotiated	Persuaded
Recruited	Reported	Rewrote	Spoke
Wrote			

RESEARCH

Clarified	Determined	Identified	Resolved
Collected	Diagnosed	Inspected	Reviewed
Concluded	Discovered	Interpreted	Summarized
Conducted	Evaluated	Interviewed	Surveyed
Constructed	Examined	Investigated	Systematized
Critiqued	Extracted	Modeled	Tested
Derived	Formed	Organized	

TEACHING

Adapted	Demystified	Facilitated	Set Goals
Advised	Developed	Guided	Stimulated
Clarified	Enabled	Informed	Studied
Coached	Encouraged	Instructed	Taught
Communicated	Evaluated	Persuaded	Trained
Coordinated	Explained		

Consider using these verbs when writing your experiences' descriptions.

QUANTITATIVE

Administered	Balanced	Forecasted	Minimized
Allocated	Budgeted	Managed	Planned
Analyzed	Calculated	Marketed	Projected
Appraised	Computed	Maximized	Researched
Audited	Developed		

TECHNICAL

Assembled	Devised	Operated	Repaired
Automated	Engineered	Optimized	Trained
Built	Fabricated	Overhauled	Solved
Calculated	Installed	Programmed	Standardized
Computed	Integrated	Prompted	Streamlined
Designed	Maintained	Remodeled	Upgraded

CREATIVE

Acted	Developed	Instituted	Published
Composed	Directed	Integrated	Redesigned
Conceived	Established	Introduced	Revised
Conceptualized	Fashioned	Invented	Revitalized
Created	Founded	Originated	Shaped
Customized	Illustrated	Performed	Visualized
Designed	Initiated	Planned	

HELPING

Assessed	Diagnosed	Guided	Referred
Assisted	Educated	Motivated	Rehabilitated
Clarified	Enhanced	Participated	Represented
Coached	Expedited	Proposed	Served
Counseled	Facilitated	Provided	Supported
Demonstrated	Familiarized	Referred	

ORGANIZATIONAL

Approved	Accelerated	Added	Broadened
Classified	Collected	Completed	Controlled
Expanded	Gained	Generated	Implemented
Operated	Organized	Processed	Purchased
Retrieved	Screened	Simplified	Sold
Systematized	Tabulated	Verified	Utilized
Cataloged	Arranged	Centralized	Changed
Defined	Completed	Dispatched	Executed
Inspected	Generated	Launched	Monitored
Recorded	Processed	Reduced	Reinforced
Specified	Simplified	Steered	Structured
Validated	Updated		



Applicant tracking system (ATS) friendly checklist

How to use: *do things as described in the checkbox, follow the flow of the checklist. Feel free to move back and forth between Readability and Further Format section. Recommended steps:*

- > Analyze the job description
- > Check readability
- > Relevancy (tailor your resume here)
- > Further formatting (optional)

Analyze the job description

- > Major/ degree in need
- > Technical skills:
 - Highlight keyword and strong verbs
 - Count number of times it appears in job description
- > Soft skills:
 - Highlight keyword and strong verbs
 - Count number of times it appears in job description

Readability

- > Open the resume in Chrome/ Adobe Acrobat Reader and make sure you can highlight/ select the text
- > Preferred single-column layout
 - Use tabs and right/left aligns instead
 - No table/ no multi-column layouts
- > PDF or .doc, .docx format only
- > Standard section titles
 - No non-standard section titles like "My career in a nutshell."
 - Avoid icons, images, creative fonts
- > Avoid icons, images, creative fonts
- > Avoid icons, graphics, pie charts, and diagrams (ATS won't process image!)
 - Avoid showing skills as bar charts or graphs
 - No textbox
- > No fancy or creative template if you are not applying for a creative role that requires a portfolio

Relevancy (It's time to tailor your resume!)

- > No keyword stuffing
 - Check (General) Princeton resume_guide_2020.pdf for useful keyword
- > Keyword included in Skills section
 - Prioritized words that shown more frequently in job description
- > Keyword included in Projects/ Work experience section
 - Use action verbs to include keyword
 - Prioritized words that shown more frequently in job description: *Use critical keywords more than once*



Applicant tracking system (ATS) friendly checklist

Relevancy (It's time to tailor your resume!)

- Same spelling and format
 - Include keyword exactly as it appears on the job description
 - Same spelling and abbreviation
 - If keyword is an acronym, include both full form and abbreviated form
 - While exact keywords are helpful, modern AI-powered ATS evaluate context. Don't just list a keyword—describe how you used it to drive growth or solve a problem. Ensure your bullet points tell a cohesive story rather than just acting as a keyword dump.
 - Use exact job title you're applying for on your resume: *Modify job title if necessary. Example: apply for Business Analyst, current title: Data Analyst → change it to "Data Analyst/ Business Analyst"*
- No buzzword
 - No "hard-working", "motivated", "determined", "team player", etc even if listed in job description
 - Demonstrate quality through actions. Example: "Delivered [project] as project manager in a cross-functional team of [x] people" for teamwork and leadership

Further formatting (optional)

- File type: safest options are pdf, .doc, and .docx
- Margin: 1 inch (preferred), at least 0.5 inch on sides
- Align: stick to left-aligning, avoid center or justify
- Header or footer: do not put important details here
- Bullet points: simple ones rather than intricate characters
- Black-colored font and normal font
- Avoid underlining and italics words
- Font size: 10 - 12pt recommended (10 to 14 is generally OK)
- Lines and borders do not touch any text
- Dates: standard format MM/DD/YYYY or Month, YYYY; avoid abbreviations, such as '19'